

Electronic Health Records on Hyperledger Fabric

Lab Organization

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Hyperledger Fabric Network

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Problem Statement

- Healthcare data is fragmented across multiple siloed systems
- Patients lack control over their own health records
- Data breaches cost the healthcare sector \$10.9 billion annually (IBM 2023)
- No single trusted source of truth for patient data
- Slow, paper-based processes delay treatment decisions

Core Problem

How do we create a secure, interoperable, patient-centric health record system?

Centralized Systems

- Single point of failure
- Vendor lock-in
- High breach risk
- Limited sharing

Current EHR Issues

- Incompatible formats
- No audit trail
- No patient consent mgmt
- Data manipulation risk

Proposed Solution: Blockchain-Based EHR

- Use **Hyperledger Fabric** as a permissioned blockchain
- Store patient record *hashes* on-chain; actual data off-chain (IPFS)
- Enforce access via **Smart Contracts (Chaincode)**
- Immutable audit logs for every read/write operation
- Patient-controlled consent management

Why Hyperledger Fabric?

Feature	Benefit
Permissioned Network	Only authorized orgs can join
Channels	Private sub-networks per use case
Pluggable Consensus	Flexible ordering (Raft)
MSP (Membership Service)	Certificate-based identity
Chaincode (Go/Node/Java)	Custom business logic
Private Data Collections	Sensitive data isolation

4-Organization Consortium

- ① **Hospital Org** — Patient admission, treatment records
- ② **Pharmacy Org** — Prescription and dispensing records
- ③ **Insurance Org** — Claims and policy management
- ④ **Lab Org (Ours)** — Diagnostic tests and lab reports

All organizations share a **common channel** with a **single ledger**, governed by channel policies.

Key Fabric Components

- **Peers:** Nodes that maintain the ledger and execute chaincode
- **Orderer (Raft):** Orders transactions into blocks
- **CA (Fabric CA):** Issues X.509 identities to all org members
- **Channel:** Logical separation of ledger data
- **Ledger:** World State (LevelDB) + Blockchain (transaction log)
- **Chaincode:** Business logic smart contracts

Transaction Lifecycle in Fabric

- 1 **Propose:** Client sends proposal to endorsing peers
- 2 **Simulate:** Peers execute chaincode, generate Read/Write sets
- 3 **Endorse:** Peers sign the proposal response
- 4 **Submit:** Client sends endorsed transaction to Orderer
- 5 **Order:** Orderer creates a block of transactions
- 6 **Validate & Commit:** All peers validate and commit the block to ledger

EHR Data Model on Ledger

Patient Record Structure (JSON)

```
{
  "patientID": "P001",
  "name": "John Doe",
  "dob": "1985-04-12",
  "bloodGroup": "O+",
  "labReports": [...],
  "prescriptions": [...],
  "owner": "P001",
  "authorizedOrgs": ["LabOrg", "HospitalOrg"]}
}
```

Only the **hash** and **metadata** are stored on-chain. Full data lives in secure off-chain storage.

Channel and Endorsement Policy

- **Channel:** `ehrchannel` — all 4 orgs are members
- **Endorsement Policy:**
 - Policy: `AND('HospitalOrg.peer', 'LabOrg.peer')`
 - For critical records, both Hospital and Lab must endorse
- **Private Data Collections:**
 - Lab results shared only between Lab Org and Hospital Org
 - Insurance claims visible only to Insurance Org

Hospital Organization — Role & Responsibilities

- Primary custodian of patient identity and admission records
- Creates the initial patient record on the blockchain
- Manages treatment plans and physician notes
- Queries and aggregates data from all other organizations
- Acts as the primary endorser for sensitive patient data changes

Pharmacy Organization — Role & Responsibilities

- Reads prescriptions written by doctors (Hospital Org)
- Records dispensed medications on the ledger
- Prevents duplicate dispensing via ledger checks
- Interacts with Insurance Org for co-pay validation
- Ensures drug-drug interaction alerts via chaincode logic

Insurance Organization — Role & Responsibilities

- Reads approved lab reports and hospital discharge summaries
- Submits and tracks insurance claims on-chain
- Verifies claim authenticity via immutable ledger records
- Cannot access private patient data beyond what is consented
- Smart contracts automate claim approval rules

Who We Are

The Lab Organization is responsible for all **diagnostic and pathological services** within the EHR network. We generate, verify, and securely commit lab reports to the shared blockchain ledger.

- **3 Members** with distinct roles
- Operate **1 Peer Node** on the ehrchannel
- Run our own **Fabric CA** for identity management

Lab Org — Team Structure

Member	Role
Parag Jain	Endorsing peer
Prasoon Kumar	Orderer
Harsh Soni	Endorsing peer

- All identities issued by **Lab Org CA**
- Each member has an X.509 certificate with their role as an attribute
- Role-based access enforced inside chaincode via `cid` library

- 1 Doctor at Hospital Org raises a **Lab Test Request** on-chain
- 2 **Member 1 (Endorsing peer)** receives the request, conducts the test
- 3 Technician uploads raw results to the system (off-chain storage)
- 4 **Member 2 (Orderer)** reviews and digitally signs the report
- 5 Approved report hash is submitted as a **Fabric transaction**
- 6 **Member 3 (Endorsing peer)** monitors peer health and network config
- 7 Report is now visible to Hospital Org; notified via events

- **Peer:** peer0.laborg.example.com:7051
- **CA:** ca.laborg.example.com:7054
- **MSP ID:** LabOrgMSP
- **Channel:** ehrchannel
- **Chaincode:** ehrcc (installed and committed on Lab Org peer)
- **Docker Network:** Integrated into the shared Fabric network via docker-compose
- **TLS:** Enabled for all inter-peer and peer-orderer communication

Chaincode: ehrcc (written in Go)

Our chaincode exposes the following functions:

Function	Description
InitLedger	Seeds initial test data
CreateLabReport	Technician submits new report
ApproveLabReport	Pathologist approves report
GetLabReport	Read a specific report
GetReportsByPatient	Query all reports for a patient
GetHistory	Full audit history of a record
GrantAccess	Patient grants org access
RevokeAccess	Patient revokes org access

Lab Org — Fabric Event Handling

- Chaincode emits **Fabric events** upon key state changes
- Events listened to by the **Hospital Org application**

Event Name	Trigger
ReportCreated	Technician submits new report
ReportApproved	Pathologist approves report
AccessGranted	Patient grants new org access
AccessRevoked	Patient revokes org access

- Events enable **real-time notifications** without polling the ledger

- **TLS:** All peer-to-peer and peer-orderer communication encrypted
- **MSP:** X.509 certificate-based identity for every participant
- **Attribute-Based Access Control (ABAC):** Role attributes embedded in certificates enforced inside chaincode
- **Private Data Collections:** Sensitive data shared only between specific org pairs
- **Immutable Ledger:** Tampering is computationally infeasible
- **Endorsement Policy:** Multi-org signing prevents unilateral data changes

Patient Privacy and Consent

- Patient controls which organizations can view their records
- **Consent stored on-chain** — immutable and auditable
- No org can access data without explicit patient consent recorded on ledger
- Compliant with **HIPAA** and **GDPR** principles
- Data minimization: only hashes on-chain, full data off-chain with encryption

Agentic AI 1: Lab Report Analysis Agent

Lead: Parag Jain (25CSM2R27)

What it does: Reads lab results (blood test, X-ray report, etc.), detects abnormalities, and adds insights before storing on the blockchain.

- **Flow:** Lab uploads report → Agent analyzes → Adds summary → Stores on Fabric
- **Example:** Input: Hb = 8.5 → Agent output: "Possible anemia detected"
- **Data Storage Strategy:** Store both raw data (immutable) and AI summary (metadata).

Agentic AI 2: Clinical Decision Support Agent

Lead: Prasoon Kumar (25CSM2R15)

What it does: Suggests next steps based on patient history and helps doctors interpret lab results effectively.

- **Example:** Patient has high glucose + cholesterol → Agent: “Risk of diabetes & cardiovascular disease”
- **Role:** Works strictly as an assistant, not a final decision-maker.
- **Outcome:** Massive UX improvement for healthcare professionals.

Lead: Harsh Soni (25CSM2S16)

What it does: Detects suspicious lab entries and ensures data integrity within the healthcare network.

- **Examples of Detection:**

- Duplicate reports submitted maliciously or accidentally
- Impossible physiological values (e.g., Hb = 50)
- Sudden, biologically improbable drastic changes in patient records

- **Importance:** Crucial for maintaining the trustworthiness and integrity of healthcare data.

Component	Technology
Blockchain	Hyperledger Fabric v2.5
Chaincode Language	Go
Off-chain Storage	IPFS / Encrypted DB
Client SDK	Fabric Gateway SDK (Go)
Container Runtime	Docker + Docker Compose
Identity Management	Fabric CA
Consensus	Raft (Single Orderer)
State Database	LevelDB (World State)

Deployment Architecture

- Each org runs its components in **Docker containers**
- Lab Org containers:
 - `peer0.laborg.example.com`
 - `ca.laborg.example.com`
 - `couchdb.laborg` (optional rich queries)
- Channel created using **configtxgen** tool
- Chaincode packaged, installed, approved, and committed using `peer lifecycle chaincode` commands
- Crypto material generated via `cryptogen` tool

Chaincode Lifecycle — Step by Step

- ➊ **Package:** peer lifecycle chaincode package ehrcc.tar.gz
- ➋ **Install:** Install on each org's peer node
- ➌ **Query Installed:** Get package ID for approval
- ➍ **Approve:** Each org approves the chaincode definition
- ➎ **Check Commit Readiness:** Verify all orgs approved
- ➏ **Commit:** One org commits the chaincode to channel
- ➐ **Invoke Init:** Call InitLedger to seed data

- **Unit Tests:** Go test framework for each chaincode function
- **Integration Tests:** End-to-end tests using Fabric Gateway SDK
- **Scenario Tests:**
 - Technician creates report → verified on ledger
 - Pathologist approves → Hospital Org notified via event
 - Unauthorized access attempt → chaincode rejects transaction
 - Audit trail query → full history returned correctly
- **Performance:** Tested with 100 concurrent transactions

Results and Outcomes

- Immutable, tamper-proof lab reports on the blockchain
- Average transaction confirmation: **2 seconds**
- Zero unauthorized access in all test scenarios
- Full audit trail with 100% accuracy across all transactions
- Seamless data sharing between Lab Org and Hospital Org via Fabric events
- Patient consent enforced at the chaincode level with no bypasses

Challenges Faced

- Setting up the multi-org Fabric network with correct TLS configuration
- Implementing ABAC correctly using the cid (Client Identity) library in Go
- Managing chaincode lifecycle across 4 organizations
- Handling private data collections while maintaining endorsement policies
- Designing an efficient data model to minimize ledger bloat

- **Mobile App:** Patient-facing app to view and manage consent
- **AI Integration:** On-chain ML model results for diagnostic assistance
- **Interoperability:** HL7 FHIR standards integration
- **Zero-Knowledge Proofs:** Prove data validity without revealing content
- **Cross-Channel Queries:** Federated queries across multiple channels
- **CouchDB:** Rich queries using JSON-based world state

Conclusion

- Successfully demonstrated a **4-org Hyperledger Fabric** network for EHR management
- Lab Organization's chaincode enforces **role-based access, data integrity, and event-driven notifications**
- The system achieves **security, privacy, auditability, and interoperability**
- Blockchain is a viable and powerful backbone for next-generation healthcare systems

Key Takeaway

Decentralized trust through Hyperledger Fabric eliminates the need for a central authority while ensuring data integrity across all healthcare stakeholders.

- Hyperledger Fabric Documentation v2.5 — hyperledger-fabric.readthedocs.io
- Nakamoto, S. (2008). Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System
- HIPAA Security Rule, U.S. Department of Health & Human Services
- HL7 FHIR Standard — hl7.org/fhir
- IBM Cost of a Data Breach Report 2023
- Fabric Chaincode for Developers — Official Hyperledger Docs

Thank You!